Mateo Susic

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EXPERIENCE

EMPRESS d.o.o. **Zenica, Bosnia and Herzegovina**
Production Manager & Assistant to the CEO Jul 2022 – Mar 2026

- Directed daily operations of a 40-person textile manufacturing floor, owning production planning, staffing, and quality control for an export-driven business (~80% of output shipped to EU clients).
- Led the company's tripling of production capacity from 4,300 sq ft to 12,900 sq ft, managing construction of the company's own facility and the move of production while keeping orders on schedule.
- Led the company's digital transformation end to end, replacing paper-based workflows with digital production tracking, order management, and automated reporting, cutting administrative time by ~30%.
- Took a new in-house brand product from TRL 4 to TRL 8 (lab-validated prototype to production-ready), coordinating design iterations, testing, and scale-up into full production.
- Optimized production by introducing new machinery and redesigning the floor layout, raising productivity by ~20%.
- Served as right hand to the CEO: prepared operational and financial reports, coordinated across production, sales, and logistics, and translated strategic decisions into shop-floor execution.
- Trained and onboarded new staff, including my successor, ensuring a smooth handover.
- Managed communication with international buyers, suppliers, and partners, coordinating export documentation and shipping schedules for 20+ clients.

CONVITA d.o.o. **Zenica, Bosnia and Herzegovina**
Project Manager – EU-Funded Projects & Marketing Jun 2023 – Sep 2024

- Implemented 2 EU-funded projects (combined budget ~€150K) from kickoff to closure, managing activity plans, budgets, procurement, deliverables, and donor reporting in line with EU requirements.
- Acted as main point of contact for 10+ stakeholders, including funding bodies, project partners, local government, and implementators; ran coordination meetings and kept all parties aligned on scope and deadlines.
- Planned and executed online marketing campaigns on Meta and Google, and designed the visuals, growing social media reach and engagement by ~40% and generating leads.

FELLOWSHIPS & CERTIFICATIONS

U.S. EMBASSY BOLD ACADEMIC FELLOWSHIP, U.S. Department of State **Syracuse & New York, NY**
Fellow; U.S. Government Exchange Alumnus Apr 2026

- Selected for a competitive U.S. Department of State exchange program for emerging leaders from Bosnia and Herzegovina, focused on entrepreneurship and economic development.
- Participated and earned Practicum in Entrepreneurship credential from Syracuse University College of Professional Studies.
- Co-developed a personal finance app and pitched the product and business model to Goldman Sachs in New York.

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF ZENICA, Polytechnic Faculty **Zenica, Bosnia and Herzegovina**
Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering Oct 2022 – Dec 2025

SAPIENZA UNIVERSITY OF ROME **Rome, Italy**
Erasmus+ Exchange, Applied Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence Oct 2024 – Jul 2025

UNITED WORLD COLLEGE OF THE ADRIATIC **Duino, Italy**
International Baccalaureate Diploma Aug 2020 – May 2022

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

E-GRUPA (Environmental Education NGO) **Bosnia and Herzegovina**
Chief Executive Officer 2018 – 2023

- Led an NGO teaching children about recycling and the environment; set strategy and led a volunteer team.
- Organized hands-on workshops and community events for children and families, and presented to schools and local partners.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Languages: English (fluent); Bosnian/Croatian/Serbian (native); Italian (intermediate); German (basic); Spanish (basic)
AI: Generative AI (ChatGPT, Claude) for automation, research, and analysis; strong understanding of LLMs and prompting
Technical: Microsoft 365, Adobe Creative Cloud, Meta Ads, Google Ads, software development fundamentals, process automation
Management: Project management, EU grant implementation, production planning, stakeholder management, team leadership
Interests: Exploring and testing new AI tools; hiking, skiing, chess, trumpet.